

Lecture Five

1 Exponential and Logarithmic Functions

1.1 Exponential Function

Definition 1.1.1 Let $a > 0$, $a \neq 1$, then the exponential function of the base a is $y = a^x$.

1.1.1 Some Properties of the exponential function

For $y = a^x$,

1. If $a > 1$, then:

- (a) $a^x > 0, \forall x \in \mathbb{R}$
- (b) $y = a^x$ is an increasing function.
- (c) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} a^x \rightarrow 0$
- (d) $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} a^x \rightarrow \infty$
- (e) $f(0) = a^0 = 1, \forall a > 1$, the graph of a^x passes through the point (0,1) on y -axis.

2. If $0 < a < 1$, then:

- (a) $a^x > 0, \forall x \in \mathbb{R}$
- (b) $y = a^x$ will be decreasing function.
- (c) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} a^x \rightarrow \infty$
- (d) $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} a^x \rightarrow 0$
- (e) $f(0) = a^0 = 1, \forall a < 1$, the graph of a^x passes through the point (0,1) on y -axis.

Theorem 1.1.1 Prove that

$$e^x = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \cdots + \frac{x^k}{k!} + \cdots = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^k}{k!}$$

Proof

We know $e^x = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(1 + \frac{x}{n}\right)^n$, now:

$$\begin{aligned} \left(1 + \frac{x}{n}\right)^n &= 1 + \binom{n}{1} \frac{x}{n} + \binom{n}{2} \frac{x^2}{n^2} + \binom{n}{3} \frac{x^3}{n^3} + \cdots + \binom{n}{k} \frac{x^k}{n^k} + \cdots \\ &= 1 + n \cdot \frac{x}{n} + \frac{n(n-1)}{2!} \frac{x^2}{n^2} + \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)}{3!} \frac{x^3}{n^3} + \cdots + \frac{n(n-1)(n-2) \cdots}{k!} \frac{x^k}{n^k} + \cdots \\ &= 1 + x + \frac{1}{2!} \left(1 - \frac{1}{n}\right) x^2 + \frac{1}{3!} \left(1 - \frac{1}{n}\right) \left(1 - \frac{2}{n}\right) x^3 + \cdots + \\ &\quad \frac{1}{k!} \left(1 - \frac{1}{n}\right) \left(1 - \frac{2}{n}\right) \cdots \left(1 - \frac{k-1}{n}\right) x^k \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $\left(1 + \frac{x}{n}\right)^n = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^k}{k!} \left(1 - \frac{1}{n}\right) \left(1 - \frac{2}{n}\right) \dots \left(1 - \frac{k-1}{n}\right)$ and this implies that:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(1 + \frac{x}{n}\right)^n = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x^k}{k!} \left(1 - \frac{1}{n}\right) \left(1 - \frac{2}{n}\right) \dots \left(1 - \frac{k-1}{n}\right) =$$

$$\Rightarrow e^x = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(1 + \frac{x}{n}\right)^n = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^k}{k!} = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \dots$$

Example 1.1.1 Evaluate the following sums using the definition of exponential function e^x :

1. $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{2^k}{k!}$

Sol

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{2^k}{k!} = \left(1 + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{2^k}{k!}\right) - 1 = \frac{2^0}{0!} + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{2^k}{k!} - 1 = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{2^k}{k!} - 1 = e^2 - 1.$$

2. $\sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k!}$

Sol

$$\sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} = 1 - 1 + \sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} = \frac{(-1)^0}{0!} + \frac{(-1)^1}{1!} + \sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} = e^{-1}.$$

3. $\sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{2^{k-1}k!}$

Sol

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{2^{k-1}k!} &= \sum_{k=2}^{\infty} 2 \times \frac{(-1)^k}{4^k k!} = 2 \times \sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{\left(\frac{-1}{4}\right)^k}{k!} = 2 \times \left[\sum_{k=2}^{\infty} \frac{\left(\frac{-1}{4}\right)^k}{k!} - 1 + \frac{1}{4} \right] \\ &= 2 \left(e^{-\frac{1}{4}} - \frac{3}{4} \right) = \frac{2}{\sqrt[4]{e}} - \frac{3}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

Example 1.1.2 Find the following limits using e^x definition.

1. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1 - e^{2x} + 2x}{x^2}$

Sol

We know that $e^x = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \dots$

This implies that $e^{2x} = 1 + 2x + \frac{4x^2}{2!} + \frac{8x^3}{3!} + \dots = 1 + 2x + 2x^2 + \frac{4}{3}x^3 + \dots$. Now:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1 - e^{2x} + 2x}{x^2} &= \frac{1 + 2x - \left(1 + 2x + 2x^2 + \frac{4}{3}x^3 + \dots\right)}{x^2} = -\frac{\left(2x^2 + \frac{4}{3}x^3 + \dots\right)}{x^2} \\ &= -\left(2 + \frac{4}{3}x + \dots\right) \\ \therefore \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1 - e^{2x} + 2x}{x^2} &= -\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \left(2 + \frac{4}{3}x + \dots\right) = -2. \end{aligned}$$

2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{e^{ax} - 1}{\sin bx}, b \neq 0$

Sol

We can write the numerator as follows:

$$e^{ax} - 1 = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(ax)^k}{k!} - 1 = \left(1 + ax + \frac{a^2x^2}{2!} + \frac{a^3x^3}{3!} + \dots\right) - 1 = ax + \frac{a^2x^2}{2!} + \frac{a^3x^3}{3!} + \dots$$

$$\begin{aligned} \therefore \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{e^{ax} - 1}{\sin bx} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{ax + \frac{a^2x^2}{2!} + \frac{a^3x^3}{3!} + \dots}{\sin bx} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{ax + \frac{a^2x^2}{2!} + \frac{a^3x^3}{3!} + \dots}{x}}{\frac{\sin bx}{x}} \\ &= \frac{\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{ax + \frac{a^2x^2}{2!} + \frac{a^3x^3}{3!} + \dots}{x}}{\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sin bx}{x}} = \frac{a}{b} \end{aligned}$$

3. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{a^x - b^x}{x}$

Sol

For you

1.1.2 Derivative of the Exponential Function

1.

$$\boxed{\frac{d}{dx} [a^{u(x)}] = a^{u(x)} \times \ln a \times \frac{du}{dx}}$$

2.

$$\boxed{\frac{d}{dx} [e^{u(x)}] = e^{u(x)} \times \ln e \times \frac{du}{dx} = u'(x)e^{u(x)}}$$

And when $u(x) = x \Rightarrow$

1.

$$\frac{d}{dx} [a^x] = a^x \ln a$$

2.

$$\frac{d}{dx} [e^x] = e^x$$

1.2 Logarithmic Functions

Definition 1.2.2 Let $a > 0$, $a \neq 1$. The **logarithmic function** of the base a is $y = \log_a x$, and it is the inverse of $y = a^x$. The domain of definition of it $D = \mathbb{R}^+ = (0, \infty)$ and $R = \mathbb{R}$.

Note that if the base is e , it is called the natural logarithm, and we denoted by $\ln x$ ($\log_e x = \ln x$) and thus $\ln x$ is the inverse of e^x .

1.2.1 Properties:

No.	log	ln
(1)	$\log_a 1 = 0$	$\ln 1 = 0$
(2)	$\log_a x + \log_a y = \log_a xy$	$\ln x + \ln y = \ln xy$
(3)	$\log_a x^n = n \log_a x$	$\ln x^n = n \ln x$
(4)	$\log_a \frac{1}{x} = -\log_a x$	$\ln \frac{1}{x} = -\ln x$
(5)	$\log_a x - \log_a y = \log_a \frac{x}{y}$	$\ln x - \ln y = \ln \frac{x}{y}$
(6)	$\log_a b = \frac{1}{\log_b a}$	$\ln b = \frac{1}{\log_b e}$
(7)	$\log_{a^n} x = \frac{1}{n} \log_a x$	$\log_{e^n} x = \frac{1}{n} \ln x$
(8)	$\log_{a^n} x^n = \log_a x$	$\log_{e^n} x^n = \ln x$

1.2.2 Derivative of Logarithmic Function

1.

$$\frac{d}{dx} [\log_a u(x)] = \frac{1}{u(x) \ln a} \times \frac{du}{dx}$$

2.

$$\frac{d}{dx} [\ln u(x)] = \frac{1}{u(x)} \times \frac{du}{dx}$$

And if $u(x) = x \Rightarrow$

1.

$$\frac{d}{dx} [\log_a x] = \frac{1}{x \ln a}$$

2.

$$\frac{d}{dx} [\ln x] = \frac{1}{x}$$

Derivative of $[f(x)]^{g(x)}$:

Let $y = (f(x))^{g(x)}$, then the derivative evaluated as follows:

$$y = [f(x)]^{g(x)} \Rightarrow \ln y = g(x) \ln f(x)$$

Now, by differentiating both sides w.r.t x , we get:

$$\frac{y'}{y} = g(x) \times \frac{f'(x)}{f(x)} + g'(x) \ln f(x)$$

Therefore the derivative will be:

$$y' = \left[g(x) \times \frac{f'(x)}{f(x)} + g'(x) \ln f(x) \right] \times y$$

Example 1.2.3 Find the first derivative of the following function:

1. $y = e^{\sin^2(4x)}$

Sol

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 2(\sin 4x) \times (4 \cos 4x) \times e^{\sin^2(4x)} = 8 \sin 4x \cos 4x e^{\sin^2(4x)}.$$

2. $y = e^{\frac{2x^2+8}{4x+1}}$

Sol

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \left(\frac{(4x+1)(4x) - (2x^2+8)(4)}{(4x+1)^2} \right) e^{\frac{2x^2+8}{4x+1}} = \frac{4x - 8x^2 - 12}{(4x+1)^2} e^{\frac{2x^2+8}{4x+1}}.$$

3. $y = x^3 e^{2x^2-1}$

Sol

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = x^3 (4x \times e^{2x^2-1}) + e^{2x^2-1} \times (3x^2) = 4x^4 e^{2x^2-1} + 3x^2 e^{2x^2-1}$$

4. $y = e^{\frac{\tan x}{\sin(\cos x)}}$

Sol

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \left[\frac{\sin(\cos x) \sec^2 x + \tan x (\sin x \cos(\cos x))}{\sin^2(\cos x)} \right] e^{\frac{\tan x}{\sin(\cos x)}}$$

Example 1.2.4 Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ for the following functions:

(a) $y = 2^x + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3^x}}$

Sol

$$y = 2^x + 3^{-\frac{x}{2}} \Rightarrow \frac{dy}{dx} = 2^x \ln 2 + 3^{-\frac{x}{2}} \times \ln 3 \times \left(-\frac{1}{2} \right) = 2^x \ln 2 - \frac{\ln 3}{2\sqrt{3^x}}$$

(b) $y = \frac{4^x - 1}{4^x + 1}$

Sol

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dy}{dx} &= \frac{(4^x + 1)(4^x \ln 4) - (4^x - 1)(4^x \ln 4)}{(4^x + 1)^2} \\ &= \frac{4^x \ln 4 (4^x + 1 - 4^x + 1)}{(4^x + 1)^2} = \frac{2^{2x+1} \ln 4}{(4^x + 1)^2}\end{aligned}$$

$$(c) \ y = x^{\sec^{-1} x}$$

Sol

By taking $\ln$ for both sides $\Rightarrow \ln y = \sec^{-1} x \ln x$, now:

$$\frac{1}{y} \frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\sec^{-1} x}{x} + \frac{\ln x}{|x| \sqrt{x^2 - 1}}$$

Therefore, the required derivative is:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \left[\frac{\sec^{-1} x}{x} + \frac{\ln x}{|x| \sqrt{x^2 - 1}} \right] x^{\sec^{-1} x}$$

$$(d) \ y = \frac{(x+1)^3(x^2+4)^8}{\sqrt[4]{x^2+2}}$$

Sol

Firstly we take the $\ln$ for both sides:

$$\begin{aligned}\ln y &= \ln \left[\frac{(x+1)^3(x^2+4)^8}{\sqrt[4]{x^2+2}} \right] \\ &= 3 \ln(x+1) + 8 \ln(x^2+4) - \frac{1}{4} \ln(x^2+2)\end{aligned}$$

Then we differentiate both sides, we get:

$$\frac{1}{y} \frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{3}{x+1} + 8 \times \frac{2x}{x^2+4} - \frac{1}{4} \frac{2x}{x^2+2}$$

Finally, we multiply both sides by y to obtain the derivative:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(x+1)^3(x^2+4)^8}{\sqrt[4]{x^2+2}} \left[\frac{3}{x+1} + \frac{16x}{x^2+4} - \frac{x}{2(x^2+2)} \right]$$

$$(e) \ x^{\sin y} = [\sin(x+y)]^y$$

Sol

By taking the $\ln$ for both sides, the given function can be written as:

$$\sin y \ln x = y \ln(\sin(x+y))$$

Now, we differentiate both sides:

$$\frac{\sin y}{x} + y' \cos(y) \ln x = y \frac{\cos(x+y)}{\sin(x+y)} (1 + y')$$

Therefore:

$$y' = \frac{y \cot(x+y) - \frac{\sin y}{x}}{\cos(y) \ln x - \cot(x+y)}$$

$$(f) \quad x = 2^y - 2^{-y}$$

Sol

Differentiate both sides directly:

$$1 = 2^y \ln 2 \frac{dy}{dx} + 2^{-y} \ln 2 \frac{dy}{dx} \Rightarrow \frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{1}{(2^y + 2^{-y}) \ln 2}$$

Exercise 1.2.1 1. Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ for the following:

$$(i) \quad y = \pi^x - x^\pi$$

Sol

$$(ii) \quad y = e^{\sin 3x}$$

Sol

$$(iii) \quad y = \ln(x^2 - 1)$$

Sol

$$(iv) \quad y = \ln \left(\frac{2^x - x}{2^x + x} \right)$$

Sol

$$(v) \quad y = \log_3 \left(\frac{x}{2^x - x} \right)$$

Sol

$$(vi) \quad y = \tan^{-1} \left(e^{-x^2} \right)$$

Sol

$$(vii) \ y = \sin \sqrt{e^x - 1}$$

Sol

$$(viii) \ y = \frac{\ln(x) + 1}{\ln(x) - 1}$$

Sol

$$(ix) \ y = \frac{(x+1)^3 \sqrt{x^2+4}}{\sqrt[3]{x+2}}$$

Sol

$$(x) \ y = \ln \left[\ln \left(\frac{x+1}{x-1} \right) \right]$$

Sol

$$(xi) \ y = \frac{\sin^4(x) \cos^3(x)}{\sqrt{x}}$$

Sol

$$(xii) \ xy = 2^{x-y}$$

Sol

$$(xiii) \ y + x = y^x$$

Sol

2. Find the following limits:

$$(a) \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{\ln x}{x - 1}$$

Sol

$$(b) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{1 - e^{2x}}{x}$$

Sol

$$(c) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{e^{ax} - e^{bx}}{x}$$

Sol

$$(d) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{e^{-x} - e^{2x}}{x}$$

Sol

$$(e) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{e^{-x^2} - 1}{x}$$

Sol